

TABLE 1.1 : THE TOPICS INCLUDED IN THE POPULATION SCHEDULE
AT THE CENSUSES IN SRI LANKA : 1871 - 1971

The Topics included in the Population Schedule	1871	1881	1891	1901	1911	1921	1931 ⁽¹⁾	1946	1953	1963	1971
DEMOGRAPHIC AND PERSONAL CHARACTERISTICS											
Name	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Relationship to head of family or household	x	x	x	-	-	-	-	x	x	x	x
Sex	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Date of birth	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x
Age	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Marital status	x	-	-	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Ethnic group or nationality	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Religion	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Citizenship	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x	x
EDUCATIONAL CHARACTERISTICS											
Ability to speak Sinhala or Tamil	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x	x	-
Ability to speak English	-	-	-	-	x	x	x	x	x	x	-
Literacy	-	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Literacy in English	-	-	-	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	-
Educational attainment	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs	x	x
School attendance	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x
ECONOMIC CHARACTERISTICS											
Type of activity	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x
Principal occupation	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	xs	x	x
Subsidiary occupation	-	-	-	x	x	x	-	-	-	-	-
Industry	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x	x	x
Employment status	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x	x	x
Salary or wages (Income)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	xs	-	-
Dependency (means of subsistence of earner on whom dependent)	-	-	-	x	x	x	x	x	x	-	-
Period for which unemployed	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs	-	x
MIGRATION AND RESIDENCE INFORMATION											
Place of birth	x	-	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	xs
Place of usual residence	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
Duration of stay at usual residence	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
Place of previous residence	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
Length of residence in Ceylon	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x	-	-
NUPTIALITY AND FERTILITY											
Date of marriage	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	xs	-	-
If previously married, date of first marriage	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	xs	-	-
Age at first marriage	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
Duration of first marriage	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
If married more than once duration of subsequent marriages	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
Age at birth of first child	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	xs	-	-
Number of children ever born	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	xs	-	xs
Number of children living	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
Date of last live birth within the past five years	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	xs
OTHER TOPICS											
Infirmary	x	x	x	x	x	x	-	x	x	x	-
Orphanhood	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	x	x	-	-

Note:

x denotes that the information was collected from all persons
xs denotes that the information was collected from a sample only.
- denotes that the information was not collected.

(1) Details were obtained from all persons within the Colombo Municipality only.
In the rest of the country only a head count was taken.

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